I thought my mum would say no.

I never even tested it. I just decided it for her, in my head, before I'd said a word.

1

“I don't have anything interesting to say.”

Nobody thinks their own life is a story. It's just Tuesday to them.

2

“Why don't you just ask me yourself?”

Because I'm too close to ask the right question at the right moment.

3

“Is this because you think I'm dying?”

No. This is about living, not dying.

4

“Is this therapy?”

No diagnosis, no digging. Just someone asking good questions and actually listening.

5

“What if they ask what I don't want to talk about?”

You draw the map first. Anything off limits stays off limits.

6

“I don't want to say this to a stranger.”

They're a stranger the first time. After that, just someone genuinely interested.

The full script is in the comments.

Every objection, every answer, word for word.